AMAZON INDIA WEB CHECKOUT

UX evaluation & redesign research

Assignment research dossier | Desktop web | One cart-to-confirmation flow | 20 October 2026

Author: Kunal Mahurkar. Independent educational evaluation; not affiliated with Amazon. Seven public evidence crops document one real checkout and cancellation. Proposed screens and prototype are independent concepts.

1. Brief, scope and method

Product: Amazon India desktop website. **Key flow:** cart, address, delivery, payment, review, confirmation. Cancellation was captured only to close the single real cash-on-delivery order. The evaluation does not extend to search, product discovery, returns, or the mobile app.

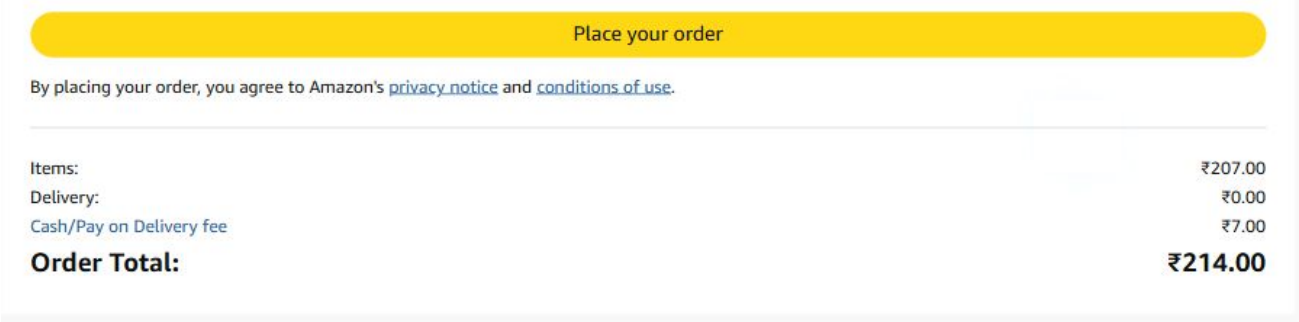
Method: one expert walkthrough of a signed-in desktop journey; seven timestamped interface crops; issue mapping to Nielsen heuristics and Hick, Fitts and Jakob; a proposed redesign; and a planned moderated usability test. I placed one cash-on-delivery order and cancelled it immediately. No real payment was made.

Evidence boundary: Screenshots prove what was shown in this journey. They do not prove confusion, slow decisions, missed clicks, conversion impact, or a site-wide defect. No participant sessions, interviews, analytics, control group, or natural payment failure were observed. Issue severity below is an expert risk estimate, not a measured outcome.

2. Evidence from the current experience

The public crops omit personal address and payment details. Original JPGs are retained in **evidence/**; presentation copies remove only visible cursor pixels. EV identifiers match **evidence/catalog.md**.

ID / stage	Directly visible	What remains unknown
EV-01 Cart	Book price, quantity control, promotion area	Attention, decision time, and click accuracy
EV-02 Address	Address step and six saved choices indicated	Private rows and editing behavior
EV-03 Payment	Card, net banking, UPI scan, COD; balance message	Method comprehension or error rate
EV-04 Delivery	Fastest and later delivery choices marked free	Preference and choice time
EV-05 Review	Item 207 rupees; COD fee 7 rupees; total 214 rupees	Whether fee was noticed before commitment
EV-06 Confirmation	Order placed state	Any population-level completion rate
EV-07 Cancellation	Cancellation success state	Failure or refund behavior



EV-05 - Real review crop: the COD fee and final total are visible. The research question is whether shoppers comprehend them before committing.

3. Six heuristic concerns: fact, interpretation and response

UX-01 | Final amount and fee

Observed: EV-05: 207-rupee item, 7-rupee COD fee, 214-rupee total are visible.

Assessment: Hypothesis: a shopper may miss the method-specific fee before committing. Visibility itself is established; confusion is not.

Principle: Nielsen #1 - visibility of system status. **Redesign:** Keep an itemized, persistent summary and label the final "Total payable."

Validation: Ask for the amount and reason for the fee before the final action. **Priority:** P1; expert severity 3/4; impact confidence low.

UX-02 | Competing choices

Observed: EV-01 shows promotion content; EV-03 several payment methods; EV-04 two delivery choices.

Assessment: Hypothesis: multiple decisions across the flow may increase effort. No delay has been measured.

Principle: Nielsen #8 - aesthetic and minimalist design. **Redesign:** Group related methods and de-emphasize secondary content while retaining access.

Validation: Record unprompted choice time, wrong turns and confidence. **Priority:** P2; severity 2/4; confidence low.

UX-03 | Late editing

Observed: EV-02 indicates saved addresses. Change links were observed during review; the public EV-05 crop concentrates on totals.

Assessment: Opportunity: direct, predictable editing with retained selections. Amazon already offers Change; absence of editing is not claimed.

Principle: Nielsen #3 - user control and freedom. **Redesign:** Place contextual Edit controls beside each choice; preserve progress on return.

Validation: Change address and payment late in checkout; check retained state. **Priority:** P2; severity 2/4; confidence low.

UX-04 | Payment language and fees

Observed: EV-03 shows card, net banking, UPI scan and pay, and cash on delivery.

Assessment: Hypothesis: some shoppers may need simpler explanations of eligibility or method-specific costs.

Principle: Nielsen #2 - match between system and real world. **Redesign:** Use plain method labels and show relevant fees alongside the choice.

Validation: Ask what each method means and what the selected method will cost. **Priority:** P2; severity 2/4; confidence low.

UX-05 | Recovery after a failed payment

Observed: No failure was observed. EV-06 shows success; EV-07 shows later cancellation.

Assessment: Design scenario only: uncertainty after payment failure would be high risk; no Amazon defect is established.

Principle: Nielsen #9 - help users recognize, diagnose and recover from errors. **Redesign:** State whether payment was taken; offer safe retry or change method; retain choices.

Validation: Use a controlled simulated failure and check status comprehension and safe recovery. **Priority:** P1 discovery; potential severity 4/4; evidence confidence very low.

UX-06 | Pointer controls

Observed: EV-01 shows quantity; review offered Change controls. Target dimensions and misses were not measured.

Assessment: Hypothesis: small or inconsistent hit areas could increase desktop pointer errors.

Principle: Nielsen #7 - flexibility and efficiency of use. **Redesign:** Give key controls consistent, generous hit areas and clear focus states.

Validation: Measure CSS targets and missed clicks during desktop tasks. **Priority:** P3; severity 2/4; confidence low.

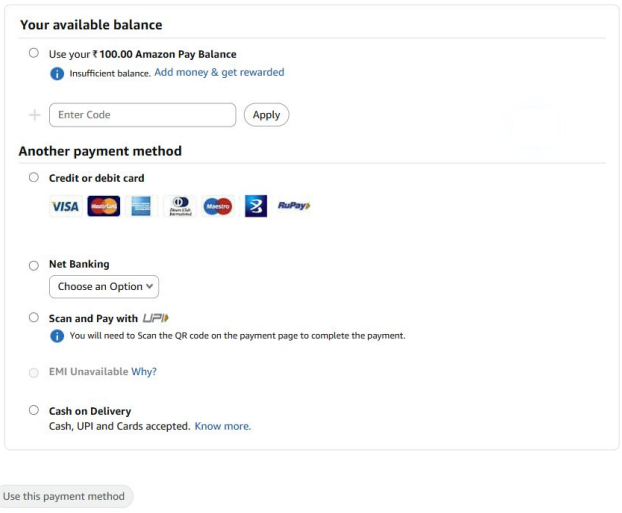
4. UX laws applied to the one checkout flow

Law / issue	Observed anchor	Design response	How to check
Hick - UX-02, 04	EV-03 shows several payment methods; EV-04 offers delivery choices.	Group methods by familiar type and place fees next to each option.	Compare choice time and understanding. No measured violation yet.
Fitts - UX-06	Quantity and Change controls were visible; target size was not recorded.	Use larger, consistent pointer targets for key actions.	Measure CSS hit areas and missed clicks.
Jakob - UX-03	Change links already exist in review.	Use familiar contextual Edit actions and retain prior choices.	Ask first-time shoppers to make a late edit without help.

These laws explain possible interaction costs and inform design decisions. They do not, by themselves, prove that the observed Amazon interface violates a law or that the redesign performs better.

5. Before / after recommendations

Current evidence	Proposed redesign	Intended benefit
EV-05: total and COD fee visible at review	Persistent itemized summary and explicit Total payable	Easier unaided cost comprehension
EV-03: several payment methods	Grouped plain-language methods with fee context	Faster, more informed choice
Review Change links already present	Contextual Edit controls with retained state	Predictable late changes
No real failure capture	Simulated failure state with safe recovery actions	Clear transaction status and next step
EV-01 quantity and review controls visible	Consistent, larger action areas	Fewer pointer misses



EV-03 - Real payment crop. The redesign is a separate concept, not a modified Amazon screenshot.

6. Priority and validation plan

P1: test cost comprehension; investigate failure recovery as a risk-led scenario. **P2:** test payment labels, grouping, and late edits. **P3:** refine target sizes after measuring interaction errors. Priority combines potential user risk, evidence confidence, and implementation effort; it is not a measured severity ranking.

Participants: five India-based desktop shoppers with varied shopping frequency and payment familiarity. **Protocol:** start at cart; change quantity; select a sample address and delivery option; choose COD; state the fee and total without prompting; edit an earlier choice from review; experience a controlled simulated failure; recover; identify confirmation. Use only synthetic data in the prototype.

Measures: unaided task success, correct total and fee, payment method comprehension, time per task, wrong turns, missed clicks, recovery success, and a 1-5 confidence rating. A task succeeds when the intended state is reached without moderator help and the relevant cost or transaction status is explained correctly.

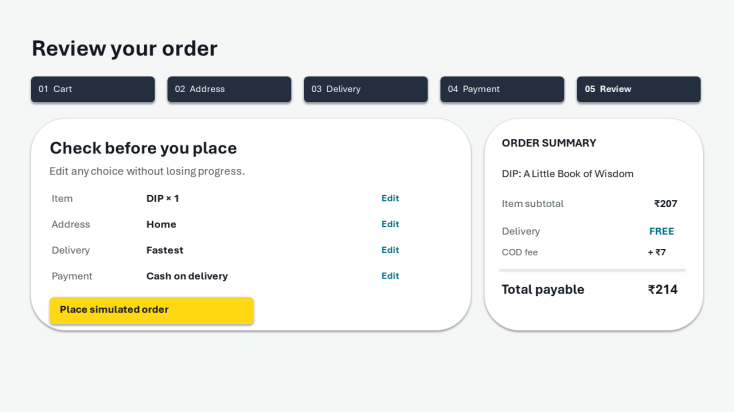
Analysis: capture task, completion, seconds, errors, participant quote, evidence ID, and proposed response. Synthesize repeated themes; do not treat five qualitative sessions as a population estimate. Get consent before screen recording. No test has yet been run.

7. Metrics, limitations and learning

Potential product measures are checkout completion, abandonment, time to confirmation, price comprehension, late-edit success, and safe recovery rate. Their baselines and any improvements remain **unmeasured**. A valid comparison needs the current flow or controlled benchmark as well as the proposed prototype.

The strongest conclusion from this work is a set of testable design priorities. One expert journey and screenshots establish interface facts but cannot establish customer harm. Real user testing should decide whether the proposed changes are useful.

Proposed review design



Independent concept: the itemized total remains beside the final action, with direct Edit controls.

Sources and artifact trail

Original screenshots and observation log: **evidence/catalog.md**. Full issue matrix and protocol: **assignment/research-and-validation.md**. Editable design source: **assignment/amazon-checkout-editable-design-source.pptx**. Interactive prototype: kunalmahurkar.is-a.dev/amazon-checkout-prototype/.

Nielsen Norman Group: 10 Usability Heuristics. Interaction Design Foundation: Hick's Law and Fitts's Law. Laws of UX: Jakob's Law.